

So if you're interested, head over to its web site: <http://www.vmware.com/products/workstation/overview.html> Click the "Try for free" link and download the software (you must register for the trial, registration is free).

After registration and accepting the terms of license, you'll be presented with an option for downloading the package for either Windows (both, 32-bit and 64-bit installations can be done from the same setup file) or for Linux (there are separate versions for 32-bit and 64-bit installations).

- ▶ **Installation for Windows:** It's just the way you install any other software on the machine. Download the package, double-click the setup file and follow the instructions on the screen. Of course, you'll need to have access to an administrator privileged account to install the package.
- ▶ **Installation for Linux:** Unlike the rest of the software you download and install for Linux, VMware Workstation has no Linux repository and you can't download its source and compile either (it's a paid and closed source program). You'll have to download the bundled package from the Download page. Pay attention to the architecture type (32-bit or 64-bit) before you download. The 32-bit version won't work on the 64-bit Linux system and vice versa. We also found that even if you have enabled 32-bit libraries for your 64-bit Linux system when you installed it, VMware Workstation fails to install. Make sure that you're downloading the right package. You wouldn't want to waste more than 300 MBs of data and the time taken to download it for nothing. In case you don't know whether your Linux system is a 64-bit or a 32-bit one, start your terminal and fire the command `uname -a`

If the line contains any of the following: i386, i486, i586 or i686 then your Linux system is a 32-bit one and if it contains x86_64 then it's a 64-bit one. Upon download, you need to make the file executable. So assuming your file is located in `/home/digit/Downloads` and the name of the file is `VMware-Workstation-Full-8.0.1-528992.i386.bundle`, you should execute the command `chmod +x /home/digit/Downloads/VMware-Workstation-Full-8.0.1-528992.i386.bundle`

That will make the file executable. Just like with Windows, you need to have the administrator (or "root") privileges. So you must either run the `su` command or add `sudo` before calling up the execution of that file. Typically, `sudo` should do it. However, with some systems (such as Fedora), a normal user isn't in the list of users who can use the `sudo` command. In those cases, you first add `su`, then go to the directory where the file is located and execute it. To execute the file, you can go to the directory where